



VALORANT CHALLENGERS SOUTH ASIA 2025 WITH INR 1.13 CR PRIZE POOL HAS KICKED OFF

Indian game producer NODWIN Gaming partnered with Riot Games for the VALORANT Challengers South Asia 2025, which began on March 4, with a prize pool of INR 1.13 crore and a new format.

The Challengers is split into three phases. Teams from Sri Lanka, India, Nepal, Bangladesh, Afghanistan, Bhutan, and the Maldives competed through open qualifiers. The final winner will secure a spot at the VALORANT Champions Tour (VCT) Ascension Pacific 2025.

Competing against the 10 best-performing teams from other regional Challengers, the winner there will earn a spot in the VCT Pacific League.



LIGHTFURY CRICKET AAA GAME WITH ESPORTS ANNOUNCED

Electronic Arts's Cricket had once become a blockbuster in the game market in the early 2000s. And now game developer LightFury Games is looking to get into the Indian market with the same sport with a new game called 'E-Cricket'.

A teaser of the game was released at the Game Developers Conference (GDC) 2025 in San Francisco on March 18 and will be developed in collaboration with Amazon GameLift Stream (AGS).

One of the game's biggest USPs is the support of AGS. This will empower gamers to enjoy high-fidelity, low-latency experiences through just a browser, eliminating the need for a dedicated gaming setup.

BUSINESS OF ESPORTS

FIFAE, the official esports ecosystem of FIFA, took a further step towards integrating content creation with gaming when it announced a talent hunt program for aspiring creators in early March.



EASTER EGG 'AFK'

AFK is an acronym for "away from keyboard", a phrase that is used to indicate that a player is not actively playing the game, either because they are away or they are just observing.



Did you know? Manchester United legend **David Beckham** is a co-owner of Guild Esports, a talent development agency launched in 2020 for esports athletes.

IESF BROADENS BASE IN AFRICA

The International Esports Federation (IESF) inducted five new national federations in March 2025, expanding to 151 members. The new members are Botswana, Central African Republic, Equatorial Guinea, Gabon, and Tanzania.

These countries will participate in the IESF 2025 season, which features titles like Counter-Strike 2, Mobile Legends: Bang Bang, PUBG Mobile, and eFootball.

IESF General Secretary Boban Totovski said, "It reflects the continued expansion of esports and the dedication of national federations to providing opportunities for athletes and communities."



WHO AM I?

I began my gaming journey in 2016 by posting Mini Militia videos on YouTube. In 2019, I won the PUBG Mobile India Series and the PUBG Mobile Club Open - Spring Split: India. I co-own S8UL.

The answer will be revealed in the next issue

